

EMRAH KALFA

Technical Product Manager | Product Owner

Istanbul, 34080 ♦

♦ emrahkalfakst@gmail.com ♦ <https://www.linkedin.com/in/emrahkalfa/>

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Results-oriented Technical Product Manager with 7+ years of experience in the software industry, specializing in SaaS and AI-driven products. Proven track record of leading cross-functional teams of 15+ members and managing the full product lifecycle from ideation to Go-to-Market (GTM). Expert in bridging the gap between business goals and technical execution by leveraging a strong engineering background (.NET, Mobile, Architecture). Skilled in Agile/Scrum methodologies, stakeholder management, and data-driven decision-making to maximize product ROI and user satisfaction.

ACCOMPLISHMENTS

1st Place Winner - Anti Coup Hackathon: Led a development team to victory by creating a "Psychological Analysis System in Social Events." Designed an AI-powered solution that analyzed public sentiment on Twitter using emotion analysis models and visualized real-time data through dynamic graphs..

WORK HISTORY

Arbalet & Emakin (Parent Company) | Istanbul, Turkey *Note: Progressed from Senior Developer to Product Manager due to technical leadership and strategic contribution.*

Technical Product Manager | 08/2025 – Present

- Leading product strategy and technical execution for the AI Agent Development Platform (Arbalet), bridging the gap between business goals and engineering.
- Product Strategy & Roadmap:** Defined the strategic vision for the AI platform, aligning technical capabilities with market needs.
- Backlog Management:** Managed the product backlog, prioritizing features based on ROI and user feedback while coordinating sprint planning.
- Cross-Functional Leadership:** Led a multidisciplinary team of 15+ staff, ensuring efficient workflow automation and user experience enhancements.
- Data-Driven Decisions:** Analyzed user feedback and competitive landscape to drive data-informed decisions for future product iterations.

Senior Backend Developer | 12/2024 – 08/2025

- Served as a core developer for both Emakin (BPM) and Arbalet products before transitioning to product management.
- Backend Architecture:** Architected and developed scalable backend infrastructure using .NET 8 and C#, ensuring high performance for dynamic data structures.
- Database Optimization:** Designed and optimized complex database schemas using PostgreSQL to handle large-scale data requirements.
- DevOps & Deployment:** Implemented containerization strategies with Docker to streamline deployment processes and ensure environment consistency.
- API Development:** Collaborated with frontend teams to design robust RESTful APIs, ensuring seamless system integration.



Product Owner Know YourX | Istanbul, Turkey | 02/2024 – 09/2024

- **Sprint & Backlog Management:** Collaborated with development teams to execute effective sprint planning and managed Project Backlog Items (PBIs), ensuring timely delivery of critical features.
- **Quality Assurance:** Planned and conducted User Acceptance Tests (UAT) to validate product usability and quality standards before release.
- **Strategic Decision Making:** Made key product decisions focused on productivity and profitability, optimizing business processes to align with company goals.
- **Process Documentation:** Created detailed workflows and diagrams to document project requirements, ensuring clarity and efficiency in communication between business and technical teams.

Startup Consultant Apphere.co | Istanbul, Turkey | 09/2023 – 06/2024

- **Agile Transformation:** Consulted on software development processes, helping the team adopt Agile methodologies and improve sprint planning efficiency.
- **Requirements Analysis:** Documented client requests into clear technical specifications for the development team, bridging the communication gap.
- **Resource Optimization:** Advised on development priorities and resource allocation to maximize productivity and streamline business operations.

Head of Project Management Office (PMO) DDTECH | Istanbul, Turkey | 08/2023 – 02/2024

- **PMO Leadership:** Established and standardized project management policies, systematizing processes from pre-sales to post-launch support.
- **Portfolio Management:** Managed resources for multiple initiated projects, prioritizing launches based on profitability and strategic value.
- **Risk Management:** Identified and analyzed potential project risks, implementing effective mitigation strategies to ensure successful project completion.
- **Team Development:** Planned training and development programs for team members, conducting performance evaluations to foster a high-performance culture.

Technical Project Manager DDTECH | Istanbul, Turkey | 03/2023 – 08/2023

- **Project Delivery:** Led cross-functional teams in developing cutting-edge identity verification systems for major industry clients.
- **Client Relations:** Fostered strong relationships with key clients, managing expectations and resolving crisis situations with a solution-oriented approach.
- **Technical Support:** Provided hands-on support in Android and backend development during resource constraints to ensure on-time delivery.

Senior Developer & Team Leader BoBu | Istanbul, Turkey | 01/2023 – 03/2023

- **Technical Leadership:** Led the software team, providing mentorship and fostering professional growth while cultivating a strong company culture.
- **Game Design:** Developed Game Design Documents (GDDs) and innovative concepts to define the company's core product objectives.

Co-Founder & Team Leader Recos Games | Istanbul, Turkey | 06/2020 – 11/2022

- **Entrepreneurship:** Defined the company's vision and strategic direction, managing all aspects of the startup lifecycle including legal processes and partnerships.
- **Full-Cycle Development:** Led the end-to-end development of game projects, designing architectural structures and conducting comprehensive testing.



SKILLS & EXPERTISE

- **Product Management & Strategy:** Product Roadmap & Strategy • Agile/Scrum & Kanban • SDLC Management • Go-to-Market (GTM) Strategy • KPI & OKR Tracking • Stakeholder Management • User Acceptance Testing (UAT) • Risk Management • Cost/Benefit Analysis • Product Discovery • User Stories • Acceptance Criteria • Backlog Refinement • Stakeholder Interviews
- **Technical Architecture & Engineering:**
- **.NET Ecosystem:** C#, .NET 8, .NET Core, ASP.NET Web API.
- **Architecture:** Microservices, Monolith to Microservice Migration, RESTful API Design, OOP, SOLID Principles, Clean Code, Design Patterns.
- **Mobile & Game:** Android Development (Kotlin/Java), Game Design Documents (GDD).
- **Database:** PostgreSQL (Complex Schema Design), SQL, NoSQL.
- **DevOps Tools:** Docker (Containerization), CI/CD Concepts, Git (Version Control).
- **AI & Emerging Tech:** AI Product Lifecycle, Workflow Automation, AI Agent Capabilities.
- **Tools & Platforms:** Jira • Azure • Confluence • MS Project • Postman (API Testing) • Figma (Basic UI/UX Collaboration).

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science: Software Engineering | Maltepe University, Istanbul | 06/2023

